

4 Maintaining and transporting the printer

The HP Photosmart 420 series GoGo Photo Studio requires very little maintenance. Follow the guidelines in this chapter to extend the life span of the printer and printing supplies, and to ensure that your prints are always of the highest quality.

For information on maintaining the HP Photosmart 420 series camera, see the *Camera User's Manual*.

Cleaning and Maintaining the Printer

Keep the printer and print cartridges clean and well maintained using the simple procedures in this section.

Cleaning the Outside of the Printer

1. Turn off the printer, then disconnect the power cord from the back of the printer.
2. If you installed the optional HP Photosmart Internal Battery in the printer, remove it, then replace the battery compartment cover.
3. Wipe the outside of the printer with a soft cloth that has been lightly moistened with water.



Caution 1 Do not use any type of cleaning solution. Household cleaners and detergents may damage the printer's finish.

Caution 2 Do not clean the interior of the printer. Keep all fluids away from the interior.

Cleaning the Print Cartridge

If you notice white lines or single-color streaks on your prints, the print cartridge may need to be cleaned. Do not clean the cartridge more often than necessary, since cleaning uses up ink.

1. Make sure the camera is in the camera dock.
2. Press **OK** to display the menu tabs.
3. Select **Clean cartridge**, then press **OK**.
4. Following the directions on the camera Image Display, load paper so the printer can print a test page after cleaning the cartridge. Use plain paper or index cards to conserve photo paper.
5. Press **OK** to begin cleaning the print cartridge.
6. When the printer finishes cleaning the cartridge and prints a test page, check the test page and select from the following options:
 - If the test page has white streaks or missing colors, the print cartridge needs to be cleaned again. Select **Yes** on the camera Image Display, then press **OK**.
 - If the print quality of the test page looks good, select **Cancel** on the camera Image Display, then press **OK**.

You can clean the cartridge up to three times. Each successive cleaning is more thorough and uses more ink.

If you complete all three levels of cleaning using this procedure and you still notice white streaks or missing colors on the test page, you may need to clean the print cartridge copper-colored contacts. For more information, see [Cleaning the Print Cartridge Contacts](#).



Note If the cartridge or printer has been recently dropped, you may also see white streaks or missing colors in your prints. This problem is temporary and clears up within 24 hours.

Cleaning the Print Cartridge Contacts

If you use the printer in a dusty environment, debris may accumulate on the copper-colored contacts and cause printing problems.

To clean the print cartridge contacts:

1. Gather the following items to clean the contacts:
 - Distilled water (tap water may contain contaminants that can damage the print cartridge)
 - Clean, dry lint-free material that will not stick to the print cartridge
2. Open the print cartridge door.
3. Remove the print cartridge and place it on a piece of paper with the ink nozzle plate facing up. Be careful not to touch the copper-colored contacts or the ink nozzle plate with your fingers.



Caution Do not leave the print cartridge outside the printer for more than 30 minutes. Ink nozzles exposed to the air longer than this may dry out and cause printing problems.

4. Lightly moisten a cotton swab with distilled water and squeeze any excess water from the swab.
5. Gently wipe the copper-colored contacts with the cotton swab.



Caution Do not touch the ink nozzle. Touching the ink nozzle will result in clogs, ink failure, and bad electrical connections.

6. Repeat steps 4–5 until no ink residue or dust appears on a clean swab.
7. Insert the print cartridge in the printer, then close the print cartridge door.

Printing a Test Page

You can print a test page that contains useful information about the print cartridge, serial number, and other aspects of the HP Photosmart GoGo Photo Studio.

1. Make sure the camera is in the camera dock.
2. Load paper in the In tray. Use plain paper or index cards to conserve photo paper.
3. Press **OK** to display the menus.
4. Select **Print Test Page**, then press **OK**.

Aligning the Print Cartridge

The first time you install a print cartridge in the printer, the printer aligns it automatically. However, if colors in printouts are misaligned, or if the alignment page